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SUBJECT: Decisions of Principals Committee Meeting on
Bosnia, May 17, 1993

1. Possible Meeting of UNSC Foreign Ministers. If a meeting of Foreign Ministers of the Security Council cannot be deferred, Secretary Christopher will attend. We will continue to make clear our belief that such a meeting should be better prepared but will not stay away if others attend.
2. Basic U.S. Policy. We will continue raising our preferred course of lifting the arms embargo on Bosnia and interim air strikes, making clear our reasons for believing it is the best course, but will not press it to the point of shattering relations with Allies or the Russians.
3. Possible Sanctions on Croatia. We will explore with EC capitals, especially Bonn, the possibility of economic sanctions on Croatia if Bosnian Croat aggression continues. Leon Fuerth's sanctions committee will begin close-hold consideration of how such sanctions might be designed, assuming no change in the situation.
4. Monitoring the Serbian-Bosnian Border. The United States will continue supporting the draft UNSC resolution on monitoring Milosevic's alleged intent to close the Bosnian-Serb border, but U.S. personnel will not participate in the monitoring effort. State will immediately clear a cable giving our ideas on how that job might be done. USUN will draw on that cable in giving technical advice to the UN Secretariat. The same advice can reach capitals via their UN missions. We would be willing to provide intelligence to a border monitoring force.
5. Preventing Spillover into Macedonia. Principals will recommend to the President that the Christmas Day 1992 warning to Milosevic on Kosovo should be publicly expanded to cover U.S. military reaction against Serbia in the case of Serbian aggression against Macedonia. JCS will provide a menu to the Principals of steps we might take to back up that warning. The basic recommendation to the President will be held until Principals can also recommend back-up steps.
6. Additional CSCE Monitors for Kosovo. State will mount a strong effort to increase the number of CSCE monitors in Kosovo. The U.S. will be willing to contribute to a larger monitoring effort.
7. A New Conference and Possible New Map. Ambassador Albright will sound out UN Secretary General Boutros-Ghali's thinking

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about a new or reconvened conference on the former Yugoslavia, in order to encourage him to call one without making a U.S. proposal to do so.

8. Air Support for Allies in UNPROFOR. The Administration will find occasion to make public (especially to Congress) the commitment we inherited from the Bush Administration to use air power to rescue Allied troops in UNPROFOR if they need and request it. We will not, however, agree to use air power to help defend safe havens that contain Allied forces, citing as necessary our basic reservations about the limits of air power and the lack of an end-point to the safe haven strategy.

9. Implementing Vance/Owen. Principals will give comments/clearance on the NSC staff's draft Presidential Decision Memorandum on U.S. participation in implementing Vance/Owen to the NSC staff. That Decision Memorandum will not go to the President, however, unless Vance/Owen seems likely to be agreed by the Bosnian Serbs.

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Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

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